

National Coverage Determination (NCD)

Prostate Cancer Screening Tests

210.1

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Tracking Information

Publication Number

100-3

Manual Section Number

210.1

Manual Section Title

Prostate Cancer Screening Tests

Version Number

2

Effective Date of this Version

06/19/2006

Implementation Date

06/19/2006

Description Information

Benefit Category

Prostate Cancer Screening Tests

Please Note: This may not be an exhaustive list of all applicable Medicare benefit categories for this item or service.

Indications and Limitations of Coverage

CIM 50-55

Covered

A. General

Section 4103 of the Balanced Budget Act of 1997 provides for coverage of certain prostate cancer screening tests subject to certain coverage, frequency, and payment limitations. Medicare will cover prostate cancer screening tests/procedures for the early detection of prostate cancer. Coverage of prostate cancer screening tests includes the following procedures furnished to an individual for the early detection of prostate cancer:

- Screening digital rectal examination; and
- Screening prostate specific antigen blood test

B. Screening Digital Rectal Examinations

Screening digital rectal examinations are covered at a frequency of once every 12 months for men who have attained age 50 (at least 11 months have passed following the month in which the last Medicare-covered screening digital rectal examination was performed). Screening digital rectal examination means a clinical examination of an individual's prostate for nodules or other abnormalities of the prostate. This screening must be performed by a doctor of medicine or osteopathy (as defined in §1861(r)(1) of the Act), or by a physician assistant, nurse practitioner, clinical nurse specialist, or certified nurse midwife (as defined in §1861(aa) and §1861(gg) of the Act) who is authorized under State law to perform the examination, fully knowledgeable about the beneficiary's medical condition, and would be responsible for using the results of any examination performed in the overall management of the beneficiary's specific medical problem.

C. Screening Prostate Specific Antigen Tests

Screening prostate specific antigen tests are covered at a frequency of once every 12 months for men who have attained age 50 (at least 11 months have passed following the month in which the last Medicare-covered screening prostate specific antigen test was performed). Screening prostate specific antigen tests (PSA) means a test to detect the marker for adenocarcinoma of prostate. PSA is a reliable immunocytochemical marker for primary and metastatic adenocarcinoma of prostate. This screening must be ordered by the beneficiary's physician or by the beneficiary's physician assistant, nurse practitioner, clinical nurse specialist, or certified nurse midwife (the term "attending physician" is defined in §1861(r)(1) of the Act to mean a doctor of medicine or osteopathy and the terms "physician assistant, nurse practitioner, clinical nurse specialist, or certified nurse midwife" are defined in §1861(aa) and §1861(gg) of the Act) who is fully knowledgeable about the beneficiary's medical condition, and who would be responsible for using the results of any examination (test) performed in the overall management of the beneficiary's specific medical problem.

Transmittal Information

Transmittal Number

48

Coverage Transmittal Link

<https://www.cms.gov/Regulations-and-Guidance/Guidance/Transmittals/Downloads/R48NCD.pdf> 

Revision History

01/2024 - Transmittal 12355 issued November 09, 2023, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 12444, January 4, 2024 to add clarifying verbiage to NCD 90.2, business requirement 13278.2, and related edits to NCD 90.2, Next Generation Sequencing, attached spreadsheet. All other information remains the same. ([TN 12444](#) ) (CR13278)

11/2023 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to provide a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 12355](#) ) (CR13278)

08/2023 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to provide a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. ([TN 12184](#) ) (CR13278)

05/2023 - The purpose of this Change Request (CR) is to provide a quarterly maintenance update of ICD-10 coding conversions and other coding updates specific to National Coverage Determination (NCDs). No policy is being changed as a result of these updates. ([TN 12017](#) ) (CR13166)

04/2023 - Transmittal 11884 issued March 01, 2023, is being rescinded and replaced by Transmittal 11952, dated, April 12, 2023, to remove the A/B MACs (Part A) and FISS from BR 13070.1 and to revise the NCD 20.4 Implantable Automatic Defibrillators (ICDs) spreadsheet. All other information remains the same. ([TN 11952](#) ) (CR13070)

02/2023 - The purpose of the Change Request (CR) is to provide a maintenance update of ICD-10 conversions and other coding updates specific to NCDs. These NCD coding changes are the result of newly available codes, coding revisions to NCDs released separately, or coding feedback received. ([TN 11832](#) ) (CR13070)

05/2014 - CMS translated the information for this policy from ICD-9-CM/PCS to ICD-10-CM/PCS according to HIPAA standard medical data code set requirements and updated any necessary and related coding infrastructure. These updates do not expand, restrict, or alter existing coverage policy. Implementation date: 10/06/2014 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1388](#) ) ([TN 1388](#) ) (CR 8691)

01/2013 - CMS translated the information for this policy from ICD-9-CM/PCS to ICD-10-CM/PCS according to HIPAA standard medical data code set requirements and updated any necessary and related coding infrastructure. These updates do not expand, restrict, or alter existing coverage policy. Implementation date: 04/01/2013 Effective date: 10/1/2015. ([TN 1165](#)) (CR 8109)

03/2006 - Delete coding information. Effective/Implementation date: 06/19/2006. ([TN 48](#)) (CR4278)

04/1999 - Provided coverage for certain prostate cancer screening tests as mandated by section 4103 of the BBA of 1997. Effective date 01/01/2000. (TN 109). Conforming regulations found at 42 CFR §410.39 (<http://www.gpo.gov/nara/cfr/index.html>)

Additional Information

Other Versions

Title	Version	Effective Between	
Prostate Cancer Screening Tests	2	06/19/2006 - N/A	You are here
Prostate Cancer Screening Tests	1	01/01/2000 - 06/19/2006	View